12–16 第一篇

The Debate About Zoos: Education vs. Animal Welfare

Zoos have been around for centuries, but today they face serious questions. Supporters say zoos educate the public, protect endangered species, and support research. Critics argue that keeping animals in captivity is cruel and that even the best enclosures cannot replace the wild. The debate is not simple—both sides raise valid points. Understanding the arguments helps us form our own views. [1]

Zoos play an important role in conservation. Many species would have gone extinct without breeding programs in zoos. Pandas, gorillas, and snow leopards are among the animals that zoos have helped save. Scientists study animal behavior and health in zoos, which can benefit both captive and wild populations. Some zoos also work with organizations to reintroduce animals into their natural habitats. [2]

On the other hand, critics point to real problems. Some zoos keep animals in spaces that are too small or boring. Animals may show signs of stress or abnormal behavior. Even in good zoos, life in captivity is very different from life in the wild. Critics also question whether seeing animals in cages really teaches respect for nature, or whether it gives people the wrong idea. [3]

Modern zoos are trying to improve. They build larger, more natural enclosures. They enrich the environment with toys, puzzles, and activities. Some focus on species that are endangered or hard to see in the wild. The best zoos put animal welfare first and use their resources for conservation and education. [4]

The future of zoos may depend on how well they balance their goals. Can they protect species and educate people while giving animals a good life? The answer is not easy, but the conversation matters. [5]

选项

A. The zoo debate involves real trade-offs between education, conservation, and animal welfare. B. Zoos have contributed to saving species and advancing scientific knowledge. C. Critics remind us that captivity can harm animals and may not serve conservation or education well. D. Many zoos are changing their practices to better meet the needs of animals. E. Finding the right balance will shape how we view and run zoos in the years to come. F. For example, the San Diego Zoo is known for its successful panda breeding program and large naturalistic habitats.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前介绍动物园历史悠久但面临质疑、支持者强调教育保护与研究、批评者认为圈养残酷、最好围栏也无法替代野外、双方都有道理、理解有助于形成观点，空后需总结争议的实质。A的"involves real trade-offs between education, conservation, and animal welfare"与前文对应。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前说动物园在保育中有重要作用、许多物种若无繁殖计划会灭绝、熊猫大猩猩雪豹等获救助、科学家研究行为与健康、部分与组织合作野放，空后需总结保育与科研贡献。B的"have contributed to saving species and advancing scientific knowledge"与前文呼应。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前说批评者指出真实问题、空间过小或单调、动物出现压力或异常行为、即便好动物园也与野外差别大、质疑笼中观看是否真能教人尊重自然，空后需总结批评者观点。C的"Critics remind us that captivity can harm animals and may not serve conservation or education well"与前文对应。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：空前说现代动物园在改进、建更大更自然的围栏、环境 enrichment、聚焦濒危或难见物种、优秀动物园以动物福利为先，空后需总结实践变革。D的"Many zoos are changing their practices to better meet the needs of animals"与前文呼应。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：空前说动物园未来取决于如何平衡目标、能否在保护与教育的同时给动物好生活、答案不易但讨论重要，空后需总结未来方向。E的"Finding the right balance will shape how we view and run zoos in the years to come"与前文对应。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, the San Diego Zoo...**：以For example开头，为具体动物园案例。各空均为概括或过渡句；[2]易被误选因涉及保育项目，但该空需总结动物园整体保育与科研贡献，而非补充某一动物园的细节。